9

CLOTH ESTIMATION

9.1 INTRODUCTION

Before embarking on garment construction it is important to have an estimate of the cloth requirement. This depends upon the width of the fabric. It is essential to know how much of cloth will be needed for a particular garment so that a suitable length can be bought before garment construction is started.

9.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- give a correct estimate of cloth according to the width of the fabric;
- explain why it is necessary to estimate cloth requirement before garment construction.

9.3 CLOTH REQUIREMENT

1. Good fitting

If cloth is bought without proper estimation, it could be too less or too much for the garment to be made. It is more then there will be wastage. If it is less, it will become difficult to make the garment. Even if the garment is made somehow, the fitting will be affected - the resultant garment many not be a well fitting one.

2. Good design

Sometimes a design requires more cloth than plain garment would need. Hence it becomes essential to estimate the cloth that would be needed for the garment.

3. Saves money

If excess cloth is bought then there is a wastage of money. If the cloth bought is less then also one has to spend extra money in buying more cloth. Hence, prior cloth estimation helps one to save money.

4. Saves time

When cloth is bought after estimation, one knows exactly how to cut the various pieces of the garment and no time is wasted. Hence cloth estimation saves time.

5. Ease of working

When cloth is bought after estimation one can easily cut it and stitch it without worrying as to how to do the work.

9.4 CLOTH ESTIMATION FOR GARMENTS

Fabrics are available in different widths in the market. Cloth estimation for any garment depends upon the width - less cloth of wider width will be needed and more cloth of narrow width will be needed for the same measurements. The cloth estimation for various garments is done as follows -

Children's garments

1. Jangia

The cloth to be used for making jangia should be soft. Generally jangia is made of new cloth.

Cloth estimation

For fabric of 70 cm width

19 cm × + 2.5 × 2

= 38 + 5 = 43 cm.

One has to buy 43 cm of cloth for the jangia.

2. Frock

Frocks are of various kinds and need different amount of cloth, such as :-

i) Plain frock

The bodice and the skirt are equal in length. After cutting the bodice pieces, two lengths of skirt and one length of sleeve, the collar pieces are cut from the side.

Measurements

Chest = 60 cm

Sleeve = 13 cm

Across shoulder = 28 cm

Full length = 55 cm

Length of skirt = 30 cm

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 90 cm

Length of skirt × 2 + turning + length of bodice × 2 + seam

30×2 + 8×2 + 25×2 + 2×2

=60+16+50+4 = 130 cm

Note : The sleeve and collar will be cut from the side.

Width of cloth = 114 cm

Skirt length × 2 + turning + length of bodice + length of sleeve

ii) Yoke frock

The bodice piece is very small in a yoke frock. The length of the bodice is subtracted from the length of the skirt.

Width of cloth = 90 cm

Skirt length × 2 + yoke length × 2 + seam + turning

Note : The sleeve and collar will be cut from the side

iii) Umbrella frock

This is also known as the round frock. The umbrella could be full umbrella or half umbrella. The full umbrella is cut on four fold cloth and needs more cloth.

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 90 cm

Bodice length + seam + skirt length × 2 + turning × 2 + sleeve length + seam + turning

Width of cloth = 70 cm

Bodice length × 2 + skirt length × 2 + 1/6 round chest + turning × 2 + seam.

3. Baba suit

The baba suit has a separate top and jangia.

Width of cloth = 90 cm

Length of top + turning + length of jangia × 2

4. Sun suit

Sun suits are those where a bib is attached to the jangia with straps at the back.

Width of cloth = 70 cm

Length of jangia × 2 + seam

Note : The bib and straps will be cut from the side

Width of cloth = 114 cm

Length of jangia

Note : The bib and straps will be cut from the side.

Ladies garments

1. Blouse

Blouse pieces are available in the market but they may sometimes be inadequate for given measurements. The cloth should be estimated according to the width of the fabric.

Measurements

Round chest = 92 cm

Round waist = 72 cm

Across shoulder = 36 cm

Across chest = 30 cm

Dart to dart = 19 cm

Shoulder to dart = 25 cm

Sleeve length = 15 cm

Full length = 36 cm

Round arm = 31 cm

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 90 cm

Length of blouse × 2 + turning + seam

36 × 2 + 4 × 2 + 2 × 1

= 72 + 8 + 2 = 82 cm

Width of cloth = 114 cm

1 length of blouse + 1 sleeve length + hem

2. Ladies shirt

If the flair is less then the ladies shirt can be made from cloth of less width. If the flair is more then some cloth is left from the sides after cutting two lengths of the shirt. Hence amount of cloth needed will be (2×length + 2×turning + 1" for shoulders). The fashion nowadays is for flaired shirts.

Width of cloth = 90 cm

Length of shirt × 2 + hem × 2 + 1 sleeve length + seam

3. Salwar

The width of the salwar varies from narrow to wide according to the prevalent fashion. Different lengths of cloth will be needed for different types of salwars.

i) 2 m salwar

This is a single panel salwar. 2 m cloth is sufficient to make a salwar of 36".

Width of cloth = 90 cm

2 × salwar length + belt + seam.

ii) **Belt salwar**

A separate broad belt is attached at the top and this kind of salwar can be made withless cloth. The length of belt is subtracted from the full length of the salwar. This allows a wider flair in the salwar,

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 90 cm

2 × length of salwar - belt + seam

Width of cloth = 70 cm

2 × length of salwar + seam + belt

iii) **1½ m salwar**

If the length of the salwar is to be 36" then one has to buy 1½ m of cloth for it. In effect one needs cloth which is 1½ times the length of salwar.

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 70 cm

1½ × length of salwar + turning + seam

4. Nighty

Nighty can be made of various designs - using lace, collars, smocking, etc. One has to buy extra cloth according to the design.

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 70 to 90 cm

2 × length of nighty + 2 × turning + 1 sleeve length + turning

Note : The width of the nighty will be less in cloth of 70 cm width.

Gents garments

1. Gents shirt

Gents shirt can be made in two ways - full open and half open. The estimation of cloth in both cases will be the same.

Measurements -

Round chest = 90cm

Length = 77 cm

Sleeve length = 60 cm

Cloth estimation

Width of cloth = 90 cm

2 × length of shirt + 1 sleeve + turning + seam.

77 × 2 + 60 + 4 + 2 = 154+60+4+2 = 220 cm.

Note : The collar, cuffs, yoke, pocket, etc will be cut from the sides.

2. Kurta

Kurta are also of various kinds like Nehru kurta, Kalidar kurta, bengali kurta, etc. The estimation of cloth for Nehru kurta and bengali kurta is the same but different for the kalidar kurta.

i) Nehru kurta

This kurta is made with a placket and pockets.

Width of cloth = 90 cm

2×length of kurta + turning + seam + 1 sleeve length + turning + seam.

Note : The placket and pockets will be cut from the side.

ii) Kalidar Kurta

This kurta is made with "kali" or panels at the side.

Width of cloth = 90 cm

2 × length of cloth + 4 × round sleeve + hem

The panels can be cut from the side but with a cloth of smaller width, the length of the kali also has to be bought.

3. Pyjama

Pyjama are also of various kinds. Although the cloth estimation is same for most types of pyjamas but it is different for the churidar pyjama.

i) Pant cut pyjama

Width of cloth = 90 cm

2 × length + belt + turning

Note : If pockets are to be made then the round button is kept smaller and the pockets are cut from the side.

ii) Plain pyjama

Width of cloth = 90cm

2×length + belt + turning

iii) Churidar pyjama

This is also made in different ways - by making a bag and without making a bag. They are also known as 'dhingri cut' and 'samosa cut' pyjamas.

Width of cloth = 90cm

1½ × length of pyjama + turning + belt + folds (churi)

Note : If more churis are desired, more cloth will be needed.

4. Knicker

Width of cloth = 70cm

2 × length of knickes + 2 × turning + seam.

Note : The fly and belt will be cut from the side.

Width of cloth = 114 cm

1 length of knicker + turning + seam.

Note : The same amount of cloth will be needed for 70 cm and 90 cm width of cloths.

Hence we can see that estimation of cloth is extremely important. The best way to do cloth estimation is by doing a layout of the garment. In this way suitable length of cloth can be bought resulting in a well fitting garment and no wastage.

9.4 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the need for cloth estimation and how to do it for different garments with different widths of cloth.